

DILLENIA
DILLENIACEAE
Genus of evergreen or briefly deciduous, spring-flowering trees, grown for their flowers and foliage and for shade. Frost tender. Needs moisture-retentive, fertile soil and full light. Water potted plants freely while in full growth, less in winter. Propagate by seed in spring. D. indica (Elephant apple). Briefly deciduous, spreading tree. H and S 25–40ft (8–12m). Has ovate, serrated, boldly parallel-veined, glossy leaves, each 1ft (30cm) long. In spring, bears nodding, cup-shaped, white flowers, each 6–8in (15–20cm) across, followed by edible, globular, greenish fruits. Z14–15 (min. 59°F/15°C)
DIMORPHOTHECA
African daisy, Cape marigold
ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE
Genus of annuals or evergreen, subshrubby perennials. Grow in sun and fertile, very well-drained soil. Deadhead to prolong flowering. Propagate annuals by seed sown under glass in midspring, perennials by semiripe cuttings in summer. Susceptible to botrytis in wet summers. D. annua . See <i>D. pluvialis</i> . D. barberae of gardens. See <i>Osteospermum jucundum</i> . D. pluvialis , syn. <i>D. annua</i> (Rain daisy), illus. p.299.
DIONAEA
DROSERACEAE
Genus of one species of evergreen, insectivorous, rosette-forming perennial. Frost tender. Needs partial shade and a humid atmosphere; grow in a mixture of peat and moss, kept constantly moist. Propagate by seed or division in spring. D. muscipula (Venus flytrap) illus. p.473.
DIONYSIA
PRIMULACEAE
Genus of evergreen, tufted or cushion forming, subshrubby perennials. Grow in an alpine house in sun and very gritty, well-drained soil. Position deep collar of grit under cushion and ensure good ventilation at all times. Dislikes winter wet. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer. Plants are susceptible to botrytis. D. aretioides illus. p.358. D. microphylla . Evergreen perennial. H 2in (5cm), S 6in (15cm). Rosettes of ovate to rounded, often sharply pointed, gray-green leaves, with a mealy, yellow coating beneath, form tight cushions. Small, short-stemmed, 5-petaled, white-eyed, pale to deep violet-yellow flowers, with darker petal bases, are borne in early spring. Z5–7 D. tapetodes illus. p.358.
DIOON
ZAMIACEAE
Genus of evergreen, palmlike cycads. Frost tender. Requires full sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Water potted specimens moderately, less when not in full growth.

Propagate by seed in spring. **D. edule** (Virgin’s palm). Slow-growing, evergreen cycad, eventually with a thick, upright trunk. H 6–12ft (2–4m), S 5–10ft (1.5–3m). Leaves are featherlike, 2–4ft (60cm–1.2m) long, with spine-tipped, blue-green leaflets. Z8–11 (min. 55°F/13°C)

DIOSCOREA

DIOSCOREACEAE

Genus of tuberous, deciduous or evergreen, climbing perennials, some of which are succulents, grown mainly for their decorative leaves. Insignificant flowers are generally yellow. Frost tender. Prefers full sun or partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by division, or by cutting off sections of tuber in spring or fall, or by seed in spring. **D. discolor**, syn. *D. dodecaneura*, (Common yam), illus. p.459. **D. dodecaneura**. See *D. discolor*. **D. elephantipes**, syn. *Testudinaria elephantipes*, illus. p.492.

Diosphaera. See *Trachelium*.

DIPCADI

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of spring-flowering bulbs, grown mainly for botanical interest. Will not tolerate cold, wet winters, so best grown in a cold frame or alpine house. Needs a warm, sunny situation and light, well-drained soil. Dormant in summer. Propagate by seed in fall. **D. serotinum** illus. p.422.

DIPELTA

CAPRIFOLIACEAE

Genus of deciduous shrubs, with bold, long-pointed leaves, grown for their showy, tubular flowers and peeling bark. After flowering, bracts beneath flowers enlarge and become papery, surrounding the fruits. Requires sun or semishade and fertile, well-drained soil. Benefits from the occasional removal of old shoots after flowering. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer. **D. floribunda** illus. p.111 **D. yunnanensis** illus. p.110.

DIPHYLLEIA

BERBERIDACEAE

Genus of perennials with creeping rootstocks and umbrella-like leaves. Best suited to woodland gardens. Needs semishade and moist soil. Propagate by division in spring or by seed in fall. **D. cymosa** (Umbrella leaf). Rounded perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 1ft (30cm). Bears large, rounded, 2-lobed leaves. In spring, has loose heads of inconspicuous, white flowers followed by indigo-blue berries on red stalks. Z7–10

DIPLACUS

Monkey Flower

PHRYMACEAE/SCROPHULARIACEAE

Genus of annuals, perennials and evergreen subshrubs and shrubs. Most need well-drained soil in sun or light

shade; some need wet soil. Propagate perennials by division in spring; subshrubs and shrubs by softwood cuttings in late summer; annuals and all species by seed in fall or spring. **D. aurantiacus**, syn. *Mimulus aurantiacus*, *M. glutinosus*, illus. p.162.

Dipladenia. See *Mandevilla*.

DIPLARRHENA

IRIDACEAE

Genus of evergreen perennials, grown for their fragrant, irislike flowers. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or by division in spring. **D. moraea** illus. p.264.

DIPSACUS

Teasel

CAPRIFOLIACEAE

Genus of biennials or short-lived perennials, grown for their flower heads, which are good for drying. Requires sun or partial shade and any fertile soil. Sow seed in fall or spring. **D. fullonum**. Prickly biennial. H 5–6ft (1.5–2m), S 12–32in (30–80cm). In the first year, produces a basal rosette of toothed, dark green leaves covered in spiny pustules. Thistlelike, pinkish-purple or white flower heads, with stiff, prickly bracts, are borne terminally on upright stems with paired leaves in mid- and late summer of the second year. Z5–8

Dipteracanthus. See *Ruellia*.

DIPTERONIA

SAPINDACEAE/ACERACEAE

Genus of deciduous trees and shrubs, grown for their foliage and fruits. Needs full sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer or by seed in fall. **D. sinensis**. Deciduous, spreading, sometimes shrubby tree. H 30ft (10m), S 20ft (6m). Large, mid-green leaves have 7–11 ovate to lance-shaped leaflets. Produces inconspicuous, greenish-white flowers in summer, followed by large clusters of winged, red fruits. Z8–10

DISA

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS. **D. uniflora**. Deciduous, terrestrial orchid. H 1½–2ft (45–60cm). Has narrowly lance-shaped, glossy, dark green leaves, to 9in (22cm) long. In early summer, each stem bears up to 7 hooded, scarlet flowers, 3–4in (8–10cm) long, with darker veins and suffused yellow. Needs partial shade and continually moist soil. Raise from seed or propagate by division of offsets when dormant. Z13–15 (min.41°F/5°C, max. 75°F/24°C)

DISANTHUS

HAMAMELIDACEAE

Genus of one species of deciduous, fall-flowering shrub, grown for its overall appearance and fall color. Needs partial

shade and humus-rich, moist but not wet, neutral to acidic soil. Propagate by layering in spring or by seed when ripe or in spring. **D. cercidifolius** illus. p.141.

DISCARIA

RHAMNACEAE

Genus of deciduous or almost leafless shrubs and small trees, grown for their habit and flowers. Spiny, green shoots assume function of leaves. Needs a sheltered, sunny site and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer. **D. toumatou** (Wild Irishman). Deciduous or almost leafless, bushy shrub. H and S 6ft (2m). Shoots have sharp, rigid spines. Tiny, star-shaped, greenish-white flowers are borne in dense clusters in late spring. Z8–9

DISOCACTUS

CACTACEAE

Genus of epiphytic, perennial cacti with flattened, strap-shaped stems. Closely related to *Epiphyllum*, with which it hybridizes. Spines are insignificant. Stems may die back after flowering. Frost tender. Needs partial shade and rich, well-drained soil. Propagate by stem cuttings in spring or summer. **D. ackermannii**, syn. *Epiphyllum ackermannii*, *Nopalxochia ackermannii* (Red orchid cactus). Erect, then pendent, epiphytic, perennial cactus. H 1ft (30cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has fleshy, toothed, green stems, to 3in (7cm) across and 16in (40cm) long, with funnel-shaped, red flowers, 6in (15cm) across, in spring–summer, along indented edges of stems. Z11–14 **D. flagelliformis**, syn. *Aporocactus flagelliformis* (Rat’s-tail cactus), illus. p.483. **D. ‘Gloria’** illus. p.485. **D. ‘Jennifer Ann’** illus. p.496. **D. ‘M.A. Jeans’** illus. p.485. **D. phyllanthoides ‘Deutsche Kaiserin’** illus. p.485.

DISPORUM

Fairy bells

COLCHICACEAE

Genus of spring- or early summer-flowering perennials. Suits a woodland garden. Requires a cool, semishaded site and humus-rich soil. Propagate by division in spring or by seed in fall. **D. hookeri**. Clump-forming perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 1ft (30cm). Leaves are narrowly ovate and mid-green. Orange-red berries in fall follow clusters of drooping, open bell-shaped, greenish-white flowers in spring. Z4–9 **D. sessile ‘Variegatum’**. Rapidly spreading, clump-forming perennial. H 18in (45cm), S 1ft (30cm). Solitary tubular-bell-shaped to bell-shaped, creamy-white flowers are produced in spring. Narrowly ovate, pleated leaves are irregularly striped with white. Z4–9

DISTICTIS

BIGNONIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, woody-stemmed, tendril climbers, grown for their colorful,